

PATNA INITIATIVE

Professional African Technical Network Advisory

Data Strategy Documentation

Step 4: Data Lifecycle Mapping

Where does data break down before it becomes a decision?

Focused on three critical VP delivery flows:

Flow 1: Community Coordination | Flow 2: Knowledge Production & Uptake | Flow 3: Policy Influence
Framework: The 6-Step Data Strategy Roadmap | Status: Working Document | March 2026

"Data doesn't create value by existing — it creates value by moving through a lifecycle: from creation, through analysis, to action and learning. Any break in that chain destroys value."

INTRODUCTION

Choosing What to Map — and Why

What This Step Does

Data Lifecycle Mapping makes visible what is usually invisible: how data actually moves through PATNA's operations, and where it stops moving before it becomes useful. Every break in the data chain is a place where the organisation cannot learn from what it does, cannot measure whether its promise is being kept, and cannot improve what it delivers.

The 6-Step framework maps seven stages in every data lifecycle: Capture → Store → Prepare → Analyse → Visualise → Act → Learn. Value is only created when the full loop completes. PATNA's data currently stops — in almost every flow — long before it reaches Act or Learn.

This document maps three flows that sit at the heart of PATNA's value proposition delivery. These are not the only data flows that matter, but they are the ones where breakdowns most directly prevent PATNA from knowing whether it is delivering on its three-pillar promise.

Flow	VP Pillar It Serves	The Chain Being Mapped	Why It's Priority
Flow 1: Community Coordination	Coordination — structured community and engagement	From member application → onboarding → community engagement → position development → coordinated contribution	Without this flow working, PATNA cannot know whether its community is active, coherent, or contributing — the foundation of the coordination promise fails silently
Flow 2: Knowledge Production & Uptake	Evidence — research and knowledge base	From knowledge creation → publishing → discovery → use by practitioners → influence on positions	Without this flow, PATNA's publications are outputs, not impact. The evidence promise requires knowledge to travel from production to decision-maker use
Flow 3: Policy Influence Tracking	Decision Intelligence — action through decision intelligence	From PATNA engagement → process contributions → tracking adoption → measuring reflection in global outcomes	Without this flow, PATNA can never demonstrate that its work changed anything. The decision intelligence promise is entirely invisible without this chain

What This Step Is Not

This mapping reflects the current state as of March 2026 — before the platform is built. It documents what actually happens today, not what should happen. The honesty of this picture is its value: it shows exactly where the platform build must deliver change, and what data architecture decisions must be made before those changes are meaningful.

FLOW 1

Community Coordination Lifecycle

What This Flow Is Measuring

PATNA's coordination promise is: 'We convene African expertise into structured, purposeful collaboration so Africa speaks with greater coherence.' This flow tracks the data chain from the moment a potential member encounters PATNA, through their onboarding, engagement in community spaces and events, and into the ultimate question: did their participation contribute to more coherent, coordinated African positions in global processes?

This is the most foundational flow in PATNA's data strategy. Without a community that is structured, active, and traceable, none of the other flows can be sustained. The member is both the input and the output of the coordination promise.

The promise being tested: A potential member hears about PATNA, applies through a governed process, joins a cohort, engages meaningfully in discussions and events, and through that engagement develops more coordinated, credible positions on energy transition and climate governance.

Flow 1 Lifecycle Map

Stage	What Happens Today	Who	Tools / Systems	Pain Points & Gaps	VP Delivery Impact
CAPTURE	Potential member encounters PATNA via event, referral, website, or partner network. Submits expression of interest through contact form or email.	Prospective member; Secretariat	Website contact form; email inbox	GAP — High No source attribution captured — impossible to know which channels generate quality applicants. No structured intake form. Applications arrive in different formats. Some are lost in email threads.	Cannot identify which outreach channels generate engaged members. Cannot build a pipeline view. Coordination promise begins blind.
STORE	Application information manually copied or held in email inbox. Some details recorded in a shared spreadsheet, inconsistently.	Secretariat	Gmail / Outlook; Google Sheets or Excel	BREAK — Critical No single system of record. Multiple versions of member lists. Application details scattered across email threads. Historical applications not searchable. No stage tracking.	No baseline member database. Cannot answer: how many members at what stage? Which cohort? Which country? The coordination promise has no roster to build on.

PREPARE	Secretariat manually reviews application, checks credentials against stated cohort interest, prepares for interview conversation.	Secretariat	Email; manual review	GAP — High Review criteria not formalised or documented. Different applications assessed differently. No scoring rubric. Cohort relevance judgment is ad-hoc. No record of review rationale.	Inconsistent cohort composition building. No evidence of assessment quality. Cannot defend decisions to declined applicants. Coordination suffers from unstructured cohort membership.
ANALYSE	Interview conducted informally. Secretariat makes approval judgment based on conversation. No structured recording of interview findings.	Secretariat; occasionally Cohort Lead consulted	Video call; email discussion	GAP — High Interview outcomes not recorded. No agreed criteria for what makes a 'good' cohort member for coordination purposes. Cohort lead input inconsistent. Decision rationale disappears after the fact.	Cannot improve screening over time. Cannot identify what member characteristics correlate with active coordination contribution. Quality of cohort is opaque.
VISUALISE	No pipeline view exists. Secretariat holds a mental model of who is at what stage. No dashboard or tracker.	Secretariat	Memory; informal notes	BREAK — Critical Leadership cannot see the state of the membership pipeline at any moment. No visibility for funders. No way to identify backlog or bottleneck without asking the individual who manages it.	Zero visibility into coordination capacity building. Cannot report to funders on community growth. Cannot make data-informed decisions about recruitment focus or outreach investment.
ACT	Approval communicated by email. Member invited to access (currently limited digital infrastructure). Introduction to cohort lead or community is informal and inconsistent.	Secretariat	Email	BREAK — Critical No structured onboarding journey. New member may or may not receive a welcome, be introduced to their cohort, or understand how to participate. Many likely disengage before contributing.	Coordination promise cannot be delivered to members who are not effectively onboarded. Community remains a list of names rather than a coordinated network. First critical failure point.
LEARN	No systematic review of cohort composition, member engagement, or onboarding effectiveness. No feedback from	None	None	BREAK — Critical PATNA cannot answer: what percentage of approved members are actively contributing? Which cohorts are	The coordination promise is entirely unmeasurable at this stage. PATNA cannot know whether its community is delivering

	new members. No tracking of who becomes active vs. who goes silent.			underrepresented? What is the drop-off rate? Is the community growing or stable? None of this is knowable.	coordination value or sitting dormant. The 3Ps and global goals connection is invisible.
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Flow 1 — Post-Platform State (Target)

The platform MVP transforms this flow. After Phase 1, the lifecycle should look like this:

Stage	Post-Platform State	Data Generated	VP KPI Unlocked
Capture	Structured application form with source attribution, cohort interest, motivation, and expertise tags	Source channel; cohort preferences; expertise profile; geography	Application source attribution; outreach channel effectiveness
Store	Centralised member database with application status tracking; each member has a profile from day one	Application records; status history; cohort assignments; profile data	Active members by cohort; geographic representation; pipeline coverage
Prepare	Systematic review with documented criteria; cohort lead input via platform; decision record retained	Review scores; cohort lead recommendations; approval rationale	Screening quality; cohort balance; review consistency
Analyse	Onboarding funnel analytics; conversion rates at each stage; time-to-activation; drop-off analysis	Stage conversion rates; cycle time per stage; interviewer performance	Application conversion rate; onboarding cycle time; bottleneck identification
Visualise	Admin dashboard showing pipeline state, cohort composition, active vs. inactive members, onboarding completion	Real-time pipeline; cohort balance chart; engagement heatmap	Leadership visibility into community health; funder-ready reporting
Act	Structured onboarding journey triggered automatically on approval; cohort space access; welcome sequence; cohort lead notification	Onboarding completion rate; first-action timestamp; cohort engagement initiation	Member activation rate; coordination capacity measurement begins
Learn	Quarterly cohort health review; feedback surveys; re-engagement triggers for inactive members; cohort composition analysis	Retention rate; engagement depth; re-activation rate; cohort balance over time	Member retention rate (12-month); active members by cohort; coordination network depth

Flow 1 — 3Ps and Global Goals Connection

Lifecycle Stage	Data Generated	People Impact	Planet / Global Goals	Profit / Sustainability
Capture + Store	Member source, geography, expertise, cohort	People: diverse African voices recruited; representation tracked by country and cohort	SDG 16: institutional capacity being built; SDG 17: partnership network growing	Demonstrates community reach to funders; supports grant applications
Prepare + Analyse	Screening quality; cohort composition; onboarding conversion	People: quality of expertise assembled for coordination work; underrepresented geographies identified	SDG 10: reduced inequalities in technical representation; UNFCCC Article 11: capacity building	Better cohort quality improves advisory service credibility and revenue potential
Visualise + Act	Onboarding completion; first engagement actions; cohort space activity	People: members successfully integrated into coordination network; peer learning initiated	IMO / UNFCCC: coordination capacity of African delegations strengthened through peer network	Retention and engagement data builds funder confidence in community sustainability
Learn	Retention rate; engagement depth; cohort health trends	People: sustained community of African experts actively contributing to coordination; institutional memory accumulating	Paris Article 11: long-term capacity building evidenced; Africa Group coordination quality improving	Recurring engaged community justifies ongoing programme investment and advisory revenue

FLOW 2

Knowledge Production & Uptake Lifecycle

What This Flow Is Measuring

PATNA's evidence promise is: 'We produce and curate knowledge grounded in African realities so positions are technically credible.' This flow tracks the data chain from the moment a knowledge product is conceived, through its creation and publication, to the critical question: did a decision-maker use this knowledge to build a better position in an actual international process?

This is the hardest flow to measure because the most important outcome — knowledge influencing a negotiated position — is distant, multi-step, and partially invisible. But it is not unmeasurable. Each stage of the lifecycle has observable data points, and the chain of evidence from production to use can be traced with the right infrastructure.

The promise being tested: A policy brief, technical analysis, or event learning note is produced by PATNA's community, published in a structured and discoverable way, found and read by a practitioner who needs it, applied to develop or strengthen an African position, and that position is reflected — with PATNA's evidence contribution traceable — in a submission or outcome document of an international process.

Flow 2 Lifecycle Map

Stage	What Happens Today	Who	Tools / Systems	Pain Points & Gaps	VP Delivery Impact
CAPTURE	Knowledge is generated through events (proceedings, learnings), commissioned research, expert analysis, or member contributions. Creation is event-driven or ad-hoc.	Secretariat; external researchers; event facilitators; members	Word documents; email; PDF tools; Google Docs	GAP — High No editorial calendar linked to the policy process calendar. Knowledge is produced reactively, not strategically timed to when decision-makers need it. Event outputs are often not documented systematically — learning disappears after the room empties.	Evidence pillar operates reactively. Key knowledge gaps relative to active IMO/UNFCCC processes go unaddressed. Knowledge that could strengthen African positions is never produced because no one identified the need.

STORE	Published content uploaded to website or distributed via email. Older content may exist on previous website versions, shared drives, or email attachments. No unified repository.	Secretariat; web manager	Website (limited); Google Drive; email	BREAK — Critical Multiple storage locations. No consistent naming or classification. Content is not tagged by theme, geography, cohort relevance, or process. Older knowledge assets are effectively lost — not findable. No version control.	Knowledge assets cannot be systematically retrieved or reused. The 'institutional memory' that PATNA promises to build doesn't exist in any functional form. A new member joining today cannot find relevant prior work.
PREPARE	No systematic preparation stage exists. Content is published roughly as created. No taxonomy applied, no cross-referencing with related content, no accessibility check for non-English speakers.	Secretariat (informally)	Manual editing; website CMS	BREAK — Critical Content has no consistent structure. Reports, briefs, event outputs, and commentary are not distinguishable by metadata. Content cannot be queried programmatically. AI-ready indexing is entirely absent.	Even if content exists, it cannot be surfaced through search, recommendation, or AI retrieval. The Phase 2 AI layer cannot function without this preparation having been done. Decision intelligence is blocked at this stage.
ANALYSE	No systematic analysis of content usage, gap coverage, or quality. No tracking of what knowledge exists vs. what the policy process calendar requires.	None formally	None	BREAK — Critical PATNA cannot answer: which themes are well-covered and which are gaps? Which content is being used? Which briefs influenced any positions? Is the knowledge base growing strategically or randomly?	No ability to allocate knowledge production resources strategically. No evidence that the evidence promise is being delivered. Content strategy is invisible to leadership and invisible to funders.
VISUALISE	No dashboard or overview of the knowledge base. Secretariat has a rough mental map but no system-level view. No content analytics visible to anyone.	None	None	BREAK — Critical Leadership cannot see what the knowledge base contains, how it is being used, or where it is growing. Funders have no visibility into knowledge asset value. Members cannot discover relevant content.	The entire value of PATNA's accumulated intellectual work is invisible. A potential partner or funder cannot assess the depth or relevance of the knowledge base without a manual tour from the Secretariat.
ACT	Practitioners access content by searching the website directly, receiving email	Members; external practitioners; delegations	Website (limited); email	BREAK — Critical Non-members cannot access member-only content. Members	The evidence promise requires knowledge to reach the right person at the right

LEARN	links, or being pointed to specific documents by the Secretariat. Discovery is primarily through personal relationship, not search.			don't know what content exists. No recommendation engine. No connection between a policy process calendar event and relevant PATNA knowledge. Content reaches people by accident, not by design.	moment. Currently, reach is entirely dependent on personal networks. Most knowledge never reaches its intended decision-making audience.
	No tracking of who accessed what content. No download counts. No citation monitoring. No feedback mechanism. No systematic review of knowledge base quality or relevance.	None	None	BREAK — Critical PATNA cannot tell whether any of its publications have ever influenced a decision, been cited, or been used in any process. The most important question — 'did our evidence change anything?' — is permanently unanswerable without this stage.	Evidence pillar is self-reported and unverifiable. Funder impact claims rest on narrative rather than data. The 3Ps and global goals connection — which requires evidence of knowledge uptake and use — is entirely missing.

Flow 2 — Post-Platform State (Target)

The platform Insights Hub and Phase 2 AI layer transform this flow. The knowledge lifecycle must be designed with measurement built in from the first publication.

Stage	Post-Platform State	Data Generated	VP KPI Unlocked
Capture	Editorial calendar linked to IMO/UNFCCC process calendar; knowledge gap analysis drives production planning; event outputs systematically captured within 2 weeks	Policy-linked production schedule; event output completeness rate; knowledge gap coverage score	Content published per process cycle; knowledge coverage by theme and geography
Store	Unified Insights Hub: all content in one system, tagged by type, theme, geography, cohort relevance, process, and language; version controlled; searchable	Full content inventory; tag coverage; content age; version history	Knowledge asset count by category; tagging completeness rate; institutional memory depth
Prepare	Structured tagging workflow before publication; AI-ready indexing applied; multilingual accessibility checked; cross-reference	Tagging completeness; indexing status; language availability; cross-reference density	AI readiness score; content discoverability index; multilingual reach coverage

	links built between related content		
Analyse	Content gap analysis run quarterly against policy process calendar; knowledge quality peer review process; content performance vs. download benchmarks	Gap coverage rate; quality review completion; content performance quartiles	Evidence coverage vs. policy calendar; knowledge quality score
Visualise	Insights Hub analytics dashboard: views, downloads, engagement time, user cohort, geography of access, top content by relevance tag	View counts; download rates; engagement depth; geographic distribution of users; cohort engagement by content type	Content downloads and views by cohort relevance; content engagement depth
Act	Search and recommendation engine in Insights Hub; process-tagged content surfaced to relevant cohort members when relevant IMO/UNFCCC meeting approaches; AI-powered Q&A (Phase 2)	Search query logs; recommendation click-through rate; AI tool usage logs	Evidence reach rate; practitioner self-reported knowledge use; AI adoption rate
Learn	Citation tracking; member feedback on content applicability; annual knowledge base review; policy submission cross-reference analysis	Citation count; applicability rating; knowledge base review findings; policy document cross-reference matches	Evidence-to-position linkage rate; practitioner confidence (surveyed); citation count in external documents

Flow 2 — The Policy Calendar Integration

The single most powerful intervention in this flow is connecting knowledge production to the international process calendar. PATNA's evidence is only valuable if it is available when decision-makers need it — before MEPC sessions, before UNFCCC SB sessions, before COP delegations are briefed. The following mapping shows the critical alignment points.

Global Process	Key Decision Windows	Knowledge PATNA Must Have Ready	Measurement: Was It Ready?
IMO Marine Environment Protection Committee (MEPC)	Biannual sessions; submission deadline ~10 weeks before each session	Technical briefs on GHG reduction measure implications for Africa; analysis of proposed mid-term measure designs; flag state implementation guidance for African administrations	PATNA content published and distributed to African delegations ≥6 weeks before MEPC submission deadline
UNFCCC COP (annual, Nov/Dec)	National delegation preparation (Aug–Oct); negotiating text finalised at COP	African NDC quality analysis; Loss & Damage mechanism briefs; Just Transition Work Programme positioning	PATNA briefs available and accessed by member-state delegation teams ≥8 weeks before COP

			papers; African Group position support documents	
UNFCCC sessions (SBSTA/SBI) June	SB —	Technical work on rulebook items; capacity building framework review	Technical notes on Article 6 carbon markets from African perspective; adaptation framework papers; capacity building programme analysis	PATNA technical notes accessed by members attending SB sessions
IMO Mid-Term GHG Measures (2025–2027 design phase)		Ongoing intersessional working group (ISWG-GHG) meetings	African state position support on Greenhouse Gas Fuel Standard and GHG levy design; economic impact analysis for African shipping	Dedicated knowledge series produced; accessed by African ISWG-GHG participants
African Union Climate Governance Forums		Variable; linked to COP cycle and AU Assembly calendar	Pan-African energy transition positioning; continental coordination papers; PATNA network synthesis briefs	Content reaches AU secretariat and member state focal points before key meetings

Flow 2 — 3Ps and Global Goals Connection

Lifecycle Stage	Data Generated	People Impact	Planet / Global Goals	Profit / Sustainability
Capture + Store	Knowledge inventory; process-linked production calendar; content classification	People: African practitioner needs identified; knowledge production responds to real decision needs	IMO/UNFCCC: knowledge available before critical process moments; policy calendar integration active	Credible, timely knowledge base supports advisory revenue and funder impact reporting
Prepare + Analyse	Tagging completeness; AI readiness; gap coverage score; content quality	People: practitioners can find relevant knowledge; non-English speakers served by multilingual tagging	SDG 13: evidence quality for climate action improved; SDG 16: institutional knowledge systems built	Knowledge quality and reach justified as programme deliverables in grant reporting
Visualise + Act	Content views and downloads; user geography; cohort engagement; recommendation use	People: knowledge reaching right people at right moments; practitioners able to make evidence-based decisions	IMO GHG Strategy: African positions technically grounded; UNFCCC NDCs: better quality with PATNA evidence	Content reach data enables value-for-money demonstration to funders
Learn	Citation counts; practitioner feedback; policy document cross-reference; knowledge uptake rate	People: sustained improvement in decision-maker confidence and position quality over successive process cycles	Paris Agreement Article 9/11: evidence of capacity building and technology/knowledge transfer to African states	Citation and uptake data builds PATNA's reputation as a credible knowledge partner, enabling advisory contracts

FLOW 3

Policy Influence Tracking Lifecycle

What This Flow Is Measuring

PATNA's decision intelligence promise is: 'We transform community and knowledge into action-ready tools and insights so decision-makers act with confidence.' At its furthest reach, this promise claims that PATNA's work influences what actually happens in international climate and energy governance processes.

This is the most analytically complex flow because influence is multi-step, contested, and partially invisible. PATNA does not control what governments decide, what IMO delegates vote for, or what text survives COP negotiations. But PATNA can — with the right data architecture — build an evidence chain that shows: its community engaged in a process, its knowledge informed positions, those positions were submitted, and some reflection of those positions appears in process outcomes.

The Attribution Principle

PATNA should not claim to have 'changed the IMO GHG Strategy.' PATNA can credibly claim: 'African positions in MEPC 81 were technically grounded in PATNA-produced evidence, were submitted by delegation members from the PATNA network, and the language on just transition safeguards in the outcome document reflects the positions PATNA supported.' That is a specific, defensible, and powerful impact claim — and it is measurable.

The promise being tested: PATNA engages in a global process through its member network, supports the development of an evidence-based African position, that position is formally submitted or advocated, and elements of it are reflected — with traceable connection to PATNA's contribution — in the language, decisions, or outcomes of the process.

Flow 3 Lifecycle Map

Stage	What Happens Today	Who	Tools / Systems	Pain Points & Gaps	VP Delivery Impact
CAPTURE	PATNA members participate in international processes (IMO MEPC, UNFCCC COP, SB sessions, intersessional working groups). Some attend as	PATNA members; Secretariat	Email; physical attendance; occasional event reports	GAP — High No systematic record of which PATNA members attended which international process sessions. Participation is known informally but not logged. No pre-event briefing register. No	Cannot build an evidence chain of participation. Cannot demonstrate that the PATNA community is present and active in the processes

	national delegation members; others as observers or advisers. Some events are convened by PATNA directly (LEAP summits, Dakar workshop).			record of which PATNA knowledge products were used in preparation.	where impact is claimed.
STORE	Post-event: some event outputs are produced (proceedings, photos, short reports). These are stored on the website or shared drives inconsistently. No systematic record linking PATNA participation to specific process sessions or outcomes.	Secretariat	Website; Google Drive; email	BREAK — Critical Participation records are anecdotal. No structured log of which members at which sessions, what roles they played (delegate, observer, technical adviser), which PATNA content they brought with them.	The institutional memory of PATNA's policy engagement does not accumulate. Each new Secretariat member starts from scratch. Funder reports describe participation but cannot demonstrate contribution quality or consistency over time.
PREPARE	No systematic preparation of policy influence tracking. No framework for what 'influence' means operationally. No methodology for attributing process language to specific PATNA positions.	None	None	BREAK — Critical PATNA has not defined its Theory of Change in operational terms that can guide measurement. The link between PATNA's work and process outcomes exists conceptually but has never been operationalised as a data collection methodology.	Cannot begin to measure policy influence without first defining what it looks like, what evidence would demonstrate it, and who is responsible for capturing it. This stage must be designed before any other investment in this flow.
ANALYSE	No comparative analysis of PATNA-supported positions vs. process outcomes. No tracking of language evolution in outcome documents. No review of which African state positions were submitted and what they contained.	None	None	BREAK — Critical The most important analytical question — 'did positions informed by PATNA's work appear in process outcomes?' — is currently unanswerable. This is not just a data gap; it is a methodology gap. The analysis design does not exist.	PATNA impact claims rest entirely on narrative and testimonial. Funders and partners are asked to take impact on trust. This is a ceiling on organisational credibility and on the revenue and partnership opportunities that credibility unlocks.

VISUALISE	Impact described in funder reports through narrative vignettes and activity counts (events held, participants reached, publications produced). No outcome-level or influence-level evidence.	Secretariat	Word documents; email-based reporting	GAP — High Impact reports are activity-based, not outcome-based. They describe what PATNA did, not what changed as a result. Funders with sophisticated evaluation frameworks will increasingly require outcome evidence.	Credibility ceiling: PATNA cannot graduate to outcome-based reporting without this stage being redesigned. Partnership and funder conversations are constrained to 'we held events' rather than 'here is what changed'.
ACT	Secretariat and members informally track whether positions were adopted, whether language appeared in outcomes, whether African interests were advanced — but this is anecdotal and person-dependent.	Secretariat; individual members	Memory; informal conversation	BREAK — Critical No formal feedback loop from process participation to PATNA strategy. If a PATNA-supported position was ignored or defeated, there is no record to learn from. If it succeeded, there is no record to replicate or report.	PATNA cannot adapt its policy engagement strategy based on evidence of what works. It cannot improve its effectiveness over successive process cycles. Strategic learning is absent.
LEARN	No systematic review of policy influence effectiveness. No comparison of PATNA engagement quality across successive sessions of the same process. No mechanism for members to share what happened after the fact.	None	None	BREAK — Critical PATNA's ability to improve its coordination and evidence quality over time — the core of the decision intelligence promise — depends entirely on knowing what worked and what didn't. Without the Learn stage, the feedback loop that makes PATNA better is permanently broken.	The decision intelligence promise is structurally unfulfillable without this stage. 'Decision intelligence' requires learning from decisions. Without the Learn stage, PATNA is not a decision intelligence system — it is a one-way broadcast.

Flow 3 — Post-Platform State (Target)

This flow requires both a platform investment (participation logging, knowledge linkage) and a methodology investment (defining what policy influence means and how to trace it). The following target state is realistic within 18–24 months.

Stage	Post-Platform State	Data Generated	VP KPI Unlocked
Capture	Process participation registry: each member registers attendance at	Member participation log by process, session, and role; pre-event knowledge use;	Policy process contributions made; PATNA member presence at key sessions

	international process sessions via platform; briefing materials accessed pre-event are logged	delegation size and country spread	
Store	Policy engagement log in platform: linked to member profiles, content accessed, event records, and post-event outcomes. Submissions database: African state IMO/UNFCCC submissions tagged and cross-referenced with PATNA knowledge	Participation history by member; submission records linked to PATNA support; process calendar tracking	Institutional memory of policy engagement; longitudinal participation trend
Prepare	Policy influence methodology agreed: define what 'reflection in outcomes' means, how to trace it, who is responsible. Position tracking template: for each process, a structured record of positions supported, submitted, and outcomes	Position tracking records; methodology documentation; attribution standard agreed	Measurement methodology for policy influence — the prerequisite for all subsequent analysis
Analyse	Cross-reference analysis: PATNA position language vs. African state submissions vs. process outcome language. Member-reported influence assessment (post-process survey). Process-by-process effectiveness scoring	Language alignment scores; member-reported influence; submission quality assessment; process effectiveness score	Evidence-to-position linkage rate; influence assessment score per process cycle
Visualise	Policy influence dashboard: participation by process, positions supported, submission quality, language tracking, member-reported outcomes. Shareable impact narrative generator for funder reporting	Dashboard data; funder-ready impact narrative; process influence summary	Outcome-level impact evidence for funder and partner reporting
Act	Annual policy engagement review: what worked, what was ignored, what should change. Platform-facilitated post-process reflection sessions with members who participated. Strategy updated based on evidence	Review findings; strategy update rationale; member feedback aggregated	Evidence-informed policy engagement strategy; year-on-year effectiveness improvement

Learn	Longitudinal effectiveness tracking: does PATNA's influence improve over successive process cycles? Are African positions strengthening over time? Is coordination coherence improving?	Longitudinal influence scores; cohort effectiveness trends; process-by-process comparison	Decision intelligence promise fulfilment score: measurable improvement in African position quality and adoption over time — PATNA's highest-order impact claim
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Flow 3 — The IMO and UNFCCC Contribution Chain

The following table operationalises PATNA's contribution to specific global processes. For each process, it identifies what measurable evidence would constitute a defensible contribution claim — moving from anecdote to data.

Process	What PATNA Contributes	Observable Evidence of Contribution	Measurement Method	Attribution Level
IMO MEPC — GHG Strategy Implementation	Technical analysis for African positions; delegation preparation; coordination of African state positions pre-session	African state MEPC submissions reference PATNA-produced content; PATNA network members in delegations; African position language appears in adopted measures	Content citation tracking; delegation registry; outcome text comparison	Contribution (not sole causation)
IMO ISWG-GHG — Mid-Term Measures Design	Position support on levy design, GHG Fuel Standard, fund access for African states	African bloc positions on mid-term measures reflect PATNA briefing language; PATNA members in ISWG-GHG delegations; just transition safeguard provisions adopted	Language comparison; member participation log; position paper cross-reference	Contribution
UNFCCC COP — NDC Quality & Ambition	National communication support; capacity building for delegation preparation; Africa Group coordination	Delegation members from PATNA network; Africa Group positions strengthen year-on-year; NDC quality indicators improve; PATNA content cited in national reports	Participation registry; NDC analysis; Africa Group position tracking	Contribution — longer causal chain
UNFCCC SB — Capacity Building Framework	Input to Article 11 capacity building review; demonstration of PATNA as a capacity building mechanism	PATNA cited as capacity building mechanism in SBI reports; network members contribute to SB technical discussions; capacity building outcomes documented	Citation monitoring; SBI document tracking; capacity outcome reporting	Contribution

LEAP Programme Outcomes	Direct programme delivery: technical capacity building, coordination, evidence production	LEAP participant governments with improved position quality; LEAP-produced evidence cited in national submissions; LEAP events generate coordinated positions	Programme evaluation; position quality assessment; citation tracking	Direct attribution (LEAP is PATNA's own programme)
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Flow 3 — 3Ps and Global Goals Connection

Lifecycle Stage	Data Generated	People Impact	Planet / Global Goals	Profit / Sustainability
Capture + Store	Participation log; delegation records; knowledge use pre-process	People: African negotiators actively present and prepared in global processes; representation made visible	IMO/UNFCCC: PATNA-supported African presence in governance processes documented	Institutional participation data enables programme reporting and builds funder trust
Prepare + Analyse	Position tracking; submission records; language alignment	People: African positions technically grounded; quality of representation improving over successive cycles	IMO GHG 2050 target: African positions shaping implementation design; UNFCCC Paris: African NDC quality improving	Attribution evidence enables outcome-based impact reporting, unlocking higher-value funders
Visualise + Act	Influence dashboard; member feedback; strategy review outcomes	People: learning loop connects what worked to what PATNA does next; strategic capacity of the organisation improving	SDG 16: PATNA as a strong, learning institution; SDG 13: climate action quality improving through African input	Outcome-level reporting enables PATNA to command programme-level funding, not just project grants
Learn	Longitudinal effectiveness scores; cross-cycle comparison; adaptation decisions	People: PATNA's quality of support to African decision-makers demonstrably improving; community trust in PATNA as a resource deepening	Global: African positions strengthening over successive IMO and UNFCCC cycles — verifiable contribution to global climate governance quality	Decision intelligence as a demonstrated capability opens advisory market, builds institutional reputation, and justifies sustained investment

PART FOUR

Consolidated High-Impact Gap Register

Prioritising the Gaps That Block Value

Across the three lifecycle flows mapped in this document, 21 data chain breaks have been identified. Not all gaps are equal. The following register applies a single filter: which gaps, if not fixed, prevent PATNA from knowing whether its VP promise is being delivered? These are the gaps that block decisions, not those that merely cause inconvenience.

The Rule

Fix gaps that block decisions. Some inefficiencies are irritating but don't prevent value creation. Others are critical blockers of the impact measurement chain. The following register focuses on the latter — ranked by business impact on the coordination, evidence, and decision intelligence promises.

Gap Location	Gap Description	Severity	Business Impact	Recommended Fix
Flow 1 — Store	No centralised member database: all member records in email and spreadsheets, no single source of truth	Critical	PATNA cannot answer basic community health questions. No coordination capacity can be tracked or reported. Funder reporting relies on estimates.	Platform MVP: member database and profile system; centralised application tracking from day one of go-live
Flow 1 — Act	No structured onboarding journey: approved members receive an email and disappear; no cohort introduction, no engagement activation	Critical	Community coordination promise fails at the first moment of delivery. Members who could contribute to coordination are lost to disengagement before contributing.	Platform MVP: structured onboarding sequence triggered on approval; cohort space access and welcome workflow built into the member lifecycle
Flow 2 — Store	No unified knowledge repository: content in multiple locations, untagged, unsearchable, not linked to process calendar	Critical	Evidence promise cannot be delivered because knowledge cannot be found, reused, or updated. Institutional memory is not accumulating. AI readiness is blocked entirely.	Platform MVP Phase 1: Insights Hub with unified publishing, consistent taxonomy, and search. Phase 2: AI indexing and retrieval layer

Flow 2 — Prepare	No content taxonomy: no agreed tagging system for theme, geography, cohort, process; content cannot be queried or recommended	Critical	Knowledge chain breaks at the preparation stage. Even if content exists, it cannot reach the right person at the right time. AI decision support (Phase 2) is impossible without this layer.	Pre-launch governance sprint: taxonomy agreed, tagging standards set, applied retroactively to existing content before platform launch
Flow 3 — Prepare	No policy influence methodology: no operational definition of what 'influencing an outcome' means; no framework for tracing contribution	Critical	The entire decision intelligence promise is unmeasurable without this methodology. PATNA cannot make defensible impact claims, cannot improve effectiveness, and cannot access outcome-based funding.	Immediate: convene a methodology design session with Secretariat and key members; document the attribution standard; implement as a tracking template in the platform
Flow 3 — Learn	No post-process feedback loop: members attend IMO/UNFCCC sessions but no systematic debrief, no position outcome review, no learning captured	Critical	Strategic learning is absent. PATNA repeats the same engagement approach each cycle regardless of what worked. Decision intelligence promise — improvement over time — is structurally blocked.	Platform design: post-process debrief template; cohort reflection sessions scheduled after each major process cycle; outcomes fed back into knowledge production planning
Flow 2 — Act	Knowledge does not proactively reach decision-makers: reach depends entirely on personal networks; no process-linked content surfacing	High	Evidence promise delivery is accidental. Most PATNA knowledge never reaches its intended audience. The policy calendar integration — which multiplies impact — does not exist.	Platform MVP: process-tagged content; notification system for members when relevant process sessions approach; editorial calendar linked to IMO/UNFCCC calendar
Flow 1 — Learn	No cohort health review cadence: no quarterly review of engagement, no re-activation triggers for inactive members	High	Community health deteriorates invisibly. Coordination capacity appears stable in narrative but may be declining. No basis for targeted cohort recruitment or engagement intervention.	Platform analytics: automated cohort health dashboard; quarterly review process defined; re-engagement triggers built into member lifecycle
Flow 3 — Store	No participation registry: no structured record of which PATNA members attended	High	Cannot build an evidence chain of PATNA presence in key processes. All	Platform feature: process participation self-registration; Secretariat-maintained session

	which international process sessions		participation claims are anecdotal. Attribution of influence is impossible without presence records.	registry; linked to member profiles
Flow 2 — Capture	No editorial calendar linked to process calendar: content is produced reactively, not timed to when decision-makers need it	High	Strategic knowledge production is impossible. Knowledge is chronically late for the moments it would be most useful. Process-readiness of the evidence base is never assessed.	Governance: establish editorial planning process with quarterly review; map IMO/UNFCCC calendar 12 months ahead; identify knowledge gaps vs. upcoming process needs
Flow 3 — Analyse	No cross-reference analysis methodology: no way to compare PATNA positions with process outcomes systematically	High	Policy influence measurement cannot begin. Impact narrative cannot upgrade from activity-based to outcome-based. Higher-value funding remains inaccessible.	Methodology design: define the text comparison approach; identify process documents to monitor; establish member-reported outcome survey process
All Flows — Learn	No data review cadence: no regular rhythm for reviewing VP KPIs at leadership level	Medium	Even when data exists, it will not improve decisions if it is not reviewed. The Review → Decide → Act loop that completes the data lifecycle is absent at the strategic level.	Governance: establish monthly VP KPI review in Secretariat; quarterly full impact review with Cohort Leads; annual strategy update grounded in evidence

Gap Prioritisation — The Fix Sequence

The gaps above cannot all be addressed simultaneously. The following sequence reflects the constraint identified in Step 3: technology and governance are co-dependent. Build the platform and the governance architecture in the right order.

Phase	Timeframe	Gaps Addressed	Why This Sequence
Phase 0: Governance Sprint (before platform launch)	Weeks 1–4 (now)	Content taxonomy; policy influence methodology; data ownership; KPI definitions; privacy framework	None of the platform's data will be useful without these decisions. Launching the platform without a taxonomy produces unstructured data. Launching without a methodology for Flow 3 means that data will never be analysable.

Phase 1: Platform MVP	Weeks 1–4 (parallel with Phase 0)	Member database; structured onboarding; Insights Hub with tagging; basic analytics; participation registry; process-linked publishing	The platform eliminates the most critical infrastructure gaps. After this phase, Flows 1 and 2 have functional data capture for the first time. Flow 3 data collection begins.
Phase 2: Analytics & AI Layer	Months 2–4	Content AI indexing; recommendation engine; cohort health dashboard; policy influence tracking dashboard; editorial calendar system	With data flowing in a governed system, analysis and visualisation become possible. This phase turns captured data into decision-relevant insights for the first time.
Phase 3: Learning Systems	Months 4–12	Post-process feedback loops; cohort review cadence; longitudinal tracking; VP KPI review rhythm; editorial calendar linked to process calendar	The Learn stage of all three flows closes here. PATNA begins to improve its effectiveness based on evidence. The decision intelligence promise becomes operational.

Conclusion: What This Mapping Tells Us

The data lifecycle maps above reveal a consistent pattern across all three VP delivery flows. Data is being captured informally — through events, publications, and relationships — but the chain breaks at almost every subsequent stage. Storage is fragmented. Preparation is absent. Analysis is non-existent. Visualisation defaults to narrative. Action is relationship-driven, not data-driven. And learning is almost entirely absent.

The result is an organisation that is doing real, valuable, impactful work — but cannot demonstrate it. Cannot improve it systematically. Cannot tell the story of its impact with evidence. And cannot answer the question that funders, partners, and the people PATNA serves most need answered: is Africa's voice in global climate and energy governance actually getting stronger because of what PATNA does?

The Commitment This Mapping Creates

Every critical gap identified in this document becomes a specific platform design decision, governance policy, or operating procedure. The platform build is not just a technology project. It is the construction of PATNA's measurement infrastructure for its impact promise. Every feature choice must be evaluated against one question: does this help PATNA know whether it is delivering on coordination, evidence, and decision intelligence for Africa's energy transition?

Steps 5 and 6 — Value Proposition Mapping and the Data Vision — will take these gaps and build from them: deciding which specific data initiatives are worth building, and articulating where PATNA's data strategy is ultimately heading.